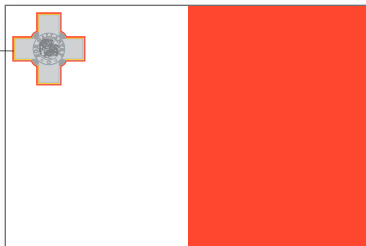


Malta

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** September 21, 1964 **Usage:** National

*The George Cross is
fimbriated with red*



Red and white
were adapted from
the badge of the
Knights of Malta

Europe



Malta was ruled successively by the Knights of St. John of Jerusalem, by Napoleon, and by Britain. It became independent in 1964.

A key stronghold during the Crusades, much of the heraldry of Malta is influenced by the colors and devices of the Knights of Malta. Their badge was the characteristic Maltese cross and their arms was a white cross on a red field. From these colors came the red and white shield that was used during the colonial period. The George Cross

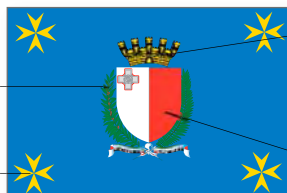
medal was added to the shield in 1943. It was awarded to the islanders by King George VI of Britain for heroism in World War II. In 1964, the blue canton on which the cross was originally placed was replaced by a red fimbriation.

The President's flag, introduced in 1988, has the shield on a blue field, with a Maltese cross in each corner.

THE PRESIDENT'S FLAG

*The wreath of olive
and palm branches
represents peace*

The Maltese cross



*A gold mural crown
with a sally port and
eight turrets represents
fortifications of Valetta*

The Shield of Malta